Speaking about the activities that the company undertook after the Tatas acquired it, Joes Sayanka, a Masai chief of the Magadi region, says that from providing educational benefits to the children of the community, to hospitals for them, water for their cattle, encouraging women in business to skill development of the youth, 'Tata has done much better, you cannot even compare to [what] Brunner Mond did'. Srivastav adds that if the company did not extend support to the community development projects, they would have 'led a different quality of life'.

Every day, in Magadi, there are long lines of cattle brought by herdsmen from miles away to the plant for water. It is critical as during shortage, 'livestock needs normally take precedence over human domestic needs'. The severe drought that killed many cattle in 1976–77 changed little with regard to the tribe's traditional reliance on them.

Today, the initial misgivings that the Kenyans had about an Indian conglomerate owning the company has dissolved into appreciation. Titus Naikuni, who joined the company under ICI and rose to become its MD in 1995 and had held important positions in the Government of Kenya, says that the apprehensions of the original inhabitants of the country has morphed into a desire to be associated with the group. He says that he too is 'very proud to be associated with Tata on account of its community relationship and ethical behaviour'. He adds that in a country where 'corruption is like religion', the Tatas' ethical ways have made a great impact and promoted clean business.

Eyeing Allied Products

In 2006, Ratan outlined yet another plan for Tata Chemicals to 'expand its product portfolio'. He proposed that it should move into 'allied businesses like agriculture, nano science and biotech' and established a group of experts to do the strategic planning for this. He said that the company was 'looking at strategic acquisitions in the country and abroad in its objective to become a global player' and would 'invest Rs 400 crore in the next three years to expand its capacities'.

In 2007, within a day of clinching the Corus deal, Ratan decided to float a JV between Tata Chemicals and Total Produce Plc (now Dole plc), Europe's largest fresh produce company, to establish Khet Se Agriproduce